

ALARM BEHAVIOUR

The power of recognising & preventing individual stress behaviour

Alarm is a specific form of (communication) stress: a growing shortfall in your own needs or expectations, which triggers negative behaviour in times of scarcity, pressure or tension. If you recognise which behaviour belongs to which shortfall, you can intervene in a very targeted way — in yourself or in others.

Recognise, acknowledge, address and prevent.



The four steps

1 Recognise

- What ALARM behaviour am I showing?
- Which style or preference does this behaviour belong to?
- Which needs or expectations belong to this style?
- Do I recognise this style or preference in myself?

2 Acknowledge

- I'm showing this negative behaviour, so I have a shortfall.
- Where do I experience a shortfall?
- How do I express that towards others?
- What is my role in a conflict or tension with others?

3 Address

- I am clear about my expectations, needs and shortfall.
- I make up for where I have shortfalls.
- Use the communication style that fits your shortfall.
- Measure your effect and impact very concretely.

4 Prevent

- Know your preferences and communication styles!
- Be aware of your needs and expectations.
- Check in times of tension: where am I falling short?
- Communicate with others about your alarm.

Reducing alarm behaviour — 5 reflection questions

1. What negative behaviour do I recognise in myself?
2. What have I lost touch with in Start and Context?
3. What can I do now for a good and healthy solution?
4. What can I ask my environment for a good and healthy solution?
5. How can I recognise my alarm behaviour earlier?

CORE NEED — Challenge

Taking on new things, raising the level of difficulty, stepping outside your comfort zone, staying in motion and stimulated, improving and daring to fail, being brave and proactive

ALARM — *"Directly confronting people"*

STAGE 1

"I need help"

ATTACKING

- Demanding change
- Nagging, exerting strong control
- Judging & blaming

STAGE 2

"I'm really annoyed and you're going to feel it."

BREAKING DOWN

- Sarcasm, sharp remarks
- Embittered when nothing changes
- Attacking the other's integrity

STAGE 3

"I'm stepping out of the connection"

DESTROYING

- Making extreme choices, taking big risks
- Anger and physical violence
- Publicly shaming others

RECHARGE — Challenge

"Get moving, go from A to B"

SELF-HELP

- Learn to finish things
- Learn to be patient
- Learn to pay more attention to detail
- Learn to set more priorities

ADVICE FOR THE ENVIRONMENT

Be clear with the Pioneer. Set boundaries and dare to be challenging. Be clear about your norms and values. Lay your cards on the table. Don't avoid honesty. Give room for their own pace, new ideas or concrete actions.

CORE NEED — Appreciation

An eye for what you do and contribute, actions not words, an active contribution from your own responsibility, clarity about task, role or assignment

ALARM — *"Working even harder"*

STAGE 1

"I need help"

PERFECTIONISM

- Demanding and overdemanding; expecting perfection
- Working harder and more routinely
- Over-organizing

STAGE 2

"I'm really annoyed and you're going to feel it."

VICTIM BEHAVIOUR

- Feeling undervalued and alone
- "Those who won't listen must feel it"
- Feeling exploited

STAGE 3

"I'm stepping out of the connection"

ISOLATING

- Depression; rejecting others
- Angry; resentful; blaming
- Lashing out physically

RECHARGE — Shoulders to the wheel

"Tell me that what I do matters"

SELF-HELP

- See saying no as an option
- Plan better
- Learn to express feelings to others
- Learn to keep an overview of what's really needed

ADVICE FOR THE ENVIRONMENT

Give the Provider appreciation for all the work done. Choose to also pick up a task or take action yourself. No long stories or deep conversations, but deeds. Be clear about short-term agreements and goals. Prefer step by step without explaining the vision. Take action, contribute to the solution and do it together.

CORE NEED — Safety

Overview, clarity, good agreements, acceptance and being able to be yourself, permission to fail, honesty with each other and a harmonious, constructive environment

ALARM — "Erasing myself"

STAGE 1

"I need help"

SELF-SACRIFICING

- Doubting yourself
- Negative statements about yourself: appearance, behaviour, qualities, performance
- Erasing yourself

STAGE 2

"I'm really annoyed and you're going to feel it."

DEPRESSION

- Making mistakes, forgetting things
- Doubting yourself, "not being seen"
- Feelings of rejection, not being enough

STAGE 3

"I'm stepping out of the connection"

SELF-REJECTION

- Total distrust of people
- Fleeing into destructive and addictive behaviour
- Experiencing life as meaningless and worthless

RECHARGE — Secure safety

"Give me an overview"

SELF-HELP

- Learn to choose for myself
- Learn to set priorities
- Learn to trust myself
- Learn not to take things personally

ADVICE FOR THE ENVIRONMENT

Give the Guardian clarity and make good agreements. Show that you accept them as they are. Show that making mistakes is allowed. Ensure honesty between each other, a harmonious and constructive environment.

CORE NEED — Affirmation

Knowing, seeing, experiencing and hearing that you're doing well, being together, gaining inspiration and staying curious, compliments and positive feedback

ALARM — *"Talking too much and too fast"*

STAGE 1

"I need help"

TOO MUCH "BROADCASTING"

- Too much: talking, exaggerating, enthusiasm
- Giving unsolicited advice
- Influencing & manipulating

STAGE 2

"I'm really annoyed and you're going to feel it."

DEFENSIVE

- Relying on standard solutions
- Denying, easily hurt: placing blame on others
- Withdrawing, turning your back on the group

STAGE 3

"I'm stepping out of the connection"

GETTING AWAY

- Backed into a corner
- Fleeing into addictions and fantasy
- Verbal violence

RECHARGE — Affirmation

"Give me a generous compliment"

SELF-HELP

- Learn to listen better to your surroundings
- Learn to stick to your own opinion
- Learn not to make promises you can't keep

ADVICE FOR THE ENVIRONMENT

Explicitly affirm the Connector and involve them in the group. Give room for curiosity and investigative power. Stand side by side. Take time for fun and for solutions that work. Don't be negative or judgmental.

CORE NEED — Support

Support and acceptance from your home situation, private life, team or work, but also practical help in achieving success and reaching goals

ALARM — *"Being demanding of yourself and others"*

STAGE 1

"I need help"

DEMANDING

- Stepping out of the process
- Or... micromanaging
- Setting the bar high for yourself and others

STAGE 2

"I'm really annoyed and you're going to feel it."

PLAN ABOVE ALL

- Using people for the plan
- Sidelineing others
- Coming across as hard-hearted and cold

STAGE 3

"I'm stepping out of the connection"

SHUTTING OUT

- Distrustful, withdrawn
- Shutting out close friends or family
- Addicted to stimulants or extreme sport

RECHARGE — Support and acceptance

"Home front: give me support"

SELF-HELP

- Relax
- Learn to deal with failure
- Dare new things
- Learn to focus on sensitivity for others

ADVICE FOR THE ENVIRONMENT

Give the Strategist reinforcement for the plans. Provide structure and don't tear everything down. Don't hinder the plans, but make the vision clear and pursue it. Be clear in your communication, be clear about progress, give good feedback, give room for own initiative.

CORE NEED — In Balance

Giving and receiving conscious gifts, time to work and time to enjoy, efficiency and quality, investment and return, hospitality and the need for privacy

ALARM — *"Becoming uncertain about money, resources or the future"*

STAGE 1

"I need help"

RESTRICTING

- Rejecting others whose lives aren't in order
- Relying on money or possessions
- Sabotaging renewal, growth or risk

STAGE 2

"I'm really annoyed and you're going to feel it."

CONTROLLING

- Giving with conditions, creating dependency
- Expecting or even demanding favours
- Excessive urge to collect or hoard

STAGE 3

"I'm stepping out of the connection"

ISOLATING

- Stingy, greedy and self-centred behaviour
- Possessions over relationships
- Shutting out the world, hiding yourself

RECHARGE — At ease

"Give me some privacy"

SELF-HELP

- Learn to give for the sake of giving
- Be content with a little less
- Pay attention to others

ADVICE FOR THE ENVIRONMENT

Give the Investor clarity. Keep talking until the issue surfaces. Together examine where the order and overview are being lost, ask whether too little is coming back from the investment. Is it time for a conscious gift or treat such as a lunch or a good glass of wine, then dress up a bit too.

CORE NEED — Recharging

Space and time to be alone and unwind, diving into your own interests, a calm environment, digging deeper, undivided attention

ALARM — "Stubbornly clinging to my own views and thoughts"

STAGE 1

"I need help"

RIGID

- Stubbornly holding onto positions
- Self-important attitude, arrogant
- Feeling uncertain, stupid and incompetent

STAGE 2

"I'm really annoyed and you're going to feel it."

SHUTTING OUT

- Rejecting people who think 'differently' than you
- Aversion to superficiality
- Sharply and critically attacking the content

STAGE 3

"I'm stepping out of the connection"

REJECTING

- Feeling misunderstood, rejected and unloved
- Punishing others by not being there
- Keeping loved ones at a distance, hurting them, shutting them out

RECHARGE — Recharging

"Listen to me with undivided attention"

SELF-HELP

- Share my thoughts with others
- Move to action more quickly
- Seek connection with my environment
- Empathise with the emotions of others

ADVICE FOR THE ENVIRONMENT

Give the Quester space and time to be alone and come to rest. Let them dive in and dig deeper into their own interests. Provide a stable environment and undivided attention for their story.